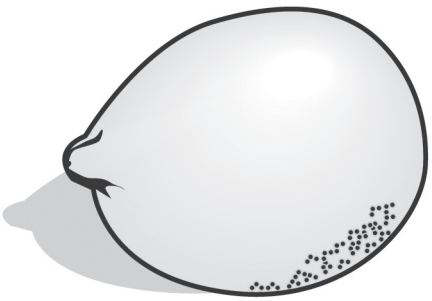
# What are acids and bases?

**Acids** and **bases** are two important groups of chemicals that have many different uses in everyday life.



☞ **1** Use the notes below to write a paragraph about **acids** in your workbook.

- very common substances used in everyday life
- contain the element hydrogen
- strong acids are dangerous because they are corrosive
- many foods are acidic, such as citrus fruits and vinegar
- a sour taste
- attack other substances
- common acids include citric acid, found in fruit, and acetic acid, which is vinegar
- common laboratory acids include hydrochloric, sulfuric and nitric acid

**2** Fill in the missing vowels (a, e, i, o, u) to complete the passage below about bases.

Bases are the chem __ c __ l opposite of ac __ ds. They have a b __ tter t __ ste and feel slippery or soapy to t __ __ ch. They are often used around the h __ me as cleaning agents. Like acids, some b __ ses are very c __ rr __ sive and therefore can be very d __ ng __ ro __ s to taste and touch. We say that those bases are c __ ust __ c. Strong bases, such as s __ dium hydr __ x __ de and p __ tassi __ m hydroxide are found in __ ven and dra __ n cleaners. Other bases are used in s __ __ ps, shampoos and d __ shwashing liq __ ids. Bases that d __ ssolv __ in w __ t __ r are called alkal __ s.

**3** Read the following list of substances. Underline the bases in red pen. Circle the acids in green.

- lemon juice
- sodium hydroxide
- vinegar
- drain cleaner
- nitric acid
- dishwashing liquid
- potassium hydroxide
- cola
- oven cleaner
- lemonade


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